



5.4 Consoles: Which one's right?

A console is a dedicated gaming machine. Every gamer dreams of having one. Consoles today are scaled down versions of your average PC. How do they perform so well, you ask? That's because all the games which are made for consoles are optimized for that particular piece of hardware, unlike PC games that have to be able to work with a wide range of hardware. For e.g. the game Halo for Xbox was optimized to work with its hardware and therefore gave stunning performance. Halo for the PC however, had to be able to work with low-end, average, as well as upper-end machines. Thus the performance of the game was not exactly stellar (no pun intended!) on the lower and average systems.

The main players in the console business are Sony and Microsoft with their respective consoles, The Playstation 2 and the Xbox. Nintendo were once top of the pile when it came to